

Booking Q3 2025 Earnings

Blind Sentiment & Directional Score: Outlook/guidance only

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Conventions (sealed before reading)

- **Outputs (exactly four):** sentiment score $\in [-1, +1]$, directional signal $\in \{\text{BUY, HOLD, SELL}\}$, structured summary, evidence quotes.
- **HOLD band:** $|\text{overnight move}| < 2.00\%$. Above $+2.00\%$, BUY is correct. Below -2.00% , SELL is correct.
- **Timing rule:** The company releases after the market close. The overnight move is defined as $(\text{next-trading-day Open} \div \text{release-day Close}) - 1$, applied identically to every report.
- **Price source:** Yahoo Finance daily OHLC pulled via the `yfinance` Python library.
- **Info-source experiment:** this read uses **Outlook/guidance only** as the ONLY report content. The other sections (the reported financial results, the earnings call Q&A) are withheld by design. Sources rotate across companies, so each company reads each source exactly once and each quarter slot contains two of each source.
- **Research:** Google is allowed for pre-release context (definitions, prior-quarter framing, analyst expectations going into the print). Not allowed before sealing: the withheld sections, the stock's price action after the release, after-hours quotes, or post-call analyst takes.
- **Pre-registered metrics:** the primary metric is the Information Coefficient (correlation between the sentiment score and the realised move); the BUY/HOLD/SELL labels are additionally scored with the Matthews Correlation Coefficient (MCC), where guessing the most common label scores zero. Both fixed in advance; no new metrics after seeing results.
- **Horizons:** returns are recorded at overnight, 1, 3, 5, 10 and 20 trading days to locate where the signal lives. The $\pm 2.00\%$ band applies to the overnight move only.

Report metadata

Company	Booking Holdings Inc. (BKNG)
Report	Q3 2025
Release date	Tuesday 28 October 2025, after close
Earnings call	4:30pm ET
Source	Motley Fool transcript
Read mode	cold; management outlook/guidance only, no reported results, no Q&A, no price chart
Time to produce	33 minutes

Source material (read ONLY this)

Forward guide (assigned source: outlook/guidance only)

- “We currently expect fourth quarter room night growth to be between 4% and 6%” (Ewout Steenbergen, CFO).
- “We currently expect fourth quarter gross bookings to increase between 11% and 13%, including about 2 percentage points of positive impact from higher flight ticket growth” (Steenbergen).

- “We currently expect fourth quarter revenue growth to be between 10% and 12%” and “fourth quarter adjusted EBITDA to be between \$2 billion and \$2.1 billion or about 14% growth at the high end” (Steenbergen).
- FX: “changes in FX will positively impact our fourth quarter U.S. dollar reported growth rates by about 5 percentage points” (Steenbergen).
- Full-year 2025 raised: room nights up about 7%, gross bookings up about 11 to 12%, revenue up about 12%, adjusted EBITDA up about 17 to 18%, adjusted EPS up slightly more than 20%.

Your scoring: fill in below, then seal

1 Sentiment score

Score: +0.20

Rationale. The full-year outlook was raised across every line, but Q4 room-night growth of 4 to 6% is a deceleration and about five points of reported growth is currency.

2 Directional signal

Signal: HOLD

Rationale. A raise, but a modest one that is heavily FX-assisted. HOLD.

3 Structured summary

- **What the source shows.** Every full-year metric was revised upward, EBITDA to 17 to 18%.
- **What the source cannot show.** No reported quarter, so cannot see the base that produced the raise.
- **Expectations bar.** Raises of this size are close to what the market anticipates from this name.
- **Conviction.** Low conviction: unit growth decelerating while reported growth is FX-flattered.

4 Evidence quotes

1. “We currently expect fourth quarter room night growth to be between 4% and 6%” (Ewout Steenbergen, CFO).
2. “We currently expect fourth quarter gross bookings to increase between 11% and 13%, including about 2 percentage points of positive impact from higher flight ticket growth” (Steenbergen).
3. “We currently expect fourth quarter revenue growth to be between 10% and 12%” and “fourth quarter adjusted EBITDA to be between \$2 billion and \$2.1 billion or about 14% growth at the high end” (Steenbergen).

— SEALED —

Overnight move and call verification

BKNG close, 28 October 2025 (release day)	\$204.82
BKNG open, 29 October 2025	\$208.00
Overnight move	+1.55%

Call verification

- HOLD band test: $|+1.55\%| < 2.00\%$, inside the band, so HOLD territory.
- Sign test: The move is inside the band, so the correct directional call is **HOLD**.
- Score given vs. correct call: signal was **HOLD**, correct call **HOLD**, so **CORRECT**.

Horizon returns (pre-registered)

For the Information Coefficient. Returns measured from the same baseline close used for the overnight move, at fixed trading-day horizons, from the single price source (yfinance). Filled only after sealing.

Horizon	Return
Overnight (baseline for the label)	+1.55%
D+1 close	−0.87%
D+3 close	−0.84%
D+5 close	−2.52%
D+10 close	−1.37%
D+20 close	−4.19%